attack overrides that.

Dr Rami Puzis, researcher in BGU Department of Software and Information Systems Engineering says, “Imagine watching and liking a cute kitty video in your Facebook feed and a day later a friend calls to find out why you liked a video of an ISIS execution.

“You log back on and find that indeed there is a like there. Repercussions from indicating support by liking something you would never do, from employers, friends, family or government enforcement unaware of this social media scam can wreak havoc in just minutes.”

In this new study, researchers explain how they penetrated individual profiles and groups in several experiments and how Online Social Network (OSN) attack, dubbed Chameleon, can be executed. The attack involves maliciously changing the way content is displayed publicly without any indication whatsoever that it was changed, until the user logs back on and sees. The post still retains the same likes and comments.

Dr Puzis explains, “Adversaries can misuse Chameleon posts to launch multiple types of social network scams. First and foremost, social network Chameleons can be used for shaming or incrimination, as well as to facilitate creation and management of fake profiles in social networks.

“They can also be used to evade censorship and monitoring, in which a disguised post reveals its true self after being approved by a moderator. Chameleon posts can also be used to unfairly collect social capital (posts, likes, links, etc) by first disguising itself as popular content and then revealing its true self and retaining the collected interactions.”

Facebook and LinkedIn partially mitigate the problem of modifications made to posts after their publication by displaying an indication that a post was edited. Other OSNs, such as Twitter or Instagram, do not allow published posts to be edited. Nevertheless, major OSNs (Facebook, Twitter and LinkedIn) allow publishing redirect links, and they support link preview updates. This allows for changing the way a post is displayed without any indication that the target content of the URLs has been changed.

In Chameleon, first the attacker collects information about the victim, an individual. The attacker creates Chameleon posts or profiles that contain redirect links and attracts the victim’s attention to Chameleon posts and profiles, in a manner similar to phishing attacks. Chameleon content builds trust within the OSN, collects social capital and interacts with the victim. This phase is important for the success of targeted and untargeted Chameleon attacks. It is similar to a general cloaking attack on the Web, but the trust of users in the OSN lowers the attack barrier.

Hyundai, Uber joining forces to launch flying taxis

South Korean carmaker Hyundai Motor wishes to take flight with Uber to develop a line of flying taxis for Uber Elevate aerial ride-hailing service. A full-scale mock-up, named S-A1, made its debut at Consumer Electronics Show 2020 in Las Vegas. The electrically-powered personal air vehicle, or PAV, will have the capability of carrying up to four passengers on trips of up to 96.56km (60 miles) at speeds reaching 289.7kph (180mph).

Uber Air partners with Hyundai to produce air taxis (Credit: https://dronedj.com)

Uber Elevate has signed up more traditional aerospace partners, including Embraer, Bell and Boeing subsidiary Aurora, but Hyundai is their first vehicle partner with the experience of manufacturing passenger cars on a global scale, as per Eric Allison, head of Uber Elevate.

First unveiled in 2016, Uber Elevate aims to expand the ride-hailing giant’s reach by linking urban centres and their suburbs, with their air taxis expected to leapfrog traffic congestion.

Clicbot, a Lego-style educational robot

Designed by Carlos Baena, Clicbot can listen, think and even react. Its personality adjusts depending on how the user builds and codes him—each setup has its own unique combination of use-cases, ensuring that Clicbot is forever-engaging and always fun. Clicbot has more than 200 reactions like nuzzling up to the user when petted, trying to find the user when he or she covers their eye and getting excited when put in the charging station.

Clicbot robot can be assembled and programmed in different configurations to perform different tasks. There are more than thousand different setups, so the users can build theirs to climb, dance, crawl, drive or even serve morning coffee.

Clicbot robot (Credit: Kickstarter)